BUSINESS RECOMMENDATION / 30-DAY VALIDATION

FinalOK: make every design approval explicit

A lightweight review-link tool for solo social media designers serving small businesses in Delhi NCR.
Decision: **test the workflow and willingness to pay before investing in a larger product.**

1 Customer, problem and opportunity

Customer. Independent designers who produce recurring Instagram posts, posters and ads for roughly 3-10 small-business clients, communicate primarily through messaging, and do not operate a formal agency portal. Geography is a starting acquisition boundary, not an established market size.

Problem hypothesis. Design feedback arrives as fragmented messages such as “nice,” “change the heading,” and “looks good.” Designers may lack a clear, version-specific approval record, risking avoidable revisions and misunderstandings. **This pain has not been verified through interviews for the assignment.**

2 Evidence versus assumptions

PUBLICLY VERIFIED / DESK RESEARCH	ASSUMPTIONS TO TEST
Canva allows view/comment collaboration. Its help says guests need to log in to add comments. [1]	Would a no-login, single-decision review feel easier for clients?
Filestage offers online proofing; its free plan allows one active project. [2]	Do solo freelancers feel existing tools are too much for simple sign-offs?
ManyRequests includes design proofing within an agency portal; Core starts at $59/month. [3]	Will the target customer pay INR 299 as a pilot rather than use chat/Canva?

These sources verify **feature availability and competitor positioning**, not that Indian freelancers have this problem or will pay. No customer interviews, surveys, signups or sales are claimed.

3 Alternatives and positioning

WhatsApp + Google Drive: familiar and often free, but approval may remain ambiguous. **Canva:** excellent design collaboration, but the desired workflow is a very simple explicit approve/revise decision, outside the editing environment. **Filestage / ManyRequests:** fuller review or agency systems, appropriate for teams with larger workflows. **FinalOK** would deliberately offer less: a fast final-decision link and a version-specific outcome.

4 Smallest useful offer

Proposed pricing: INR 299 for the first month for five founding customers, then test INR 499/month for a solo designer. This is a price hypothesis, not an estimate backed by interviews. Each plan would cover a basic set of active reviews with transparent limits to be set after usage tests.

MVP: create a project and version, attach a design image, issue a revocable client review link, capture one of two decisions (approve or changes requested), and show status with comment and timestamp. **Not in MVP:** AI-generated content, WhatsApp automation, payments, multi-user roles, complex reporting or client account creation.

From discovery to five paid pilots

The 30-day target is **five actual paying customers**; this is a future test objective, not an achieved result. No real outreach or paid activity was performed for this assignment.

5 Full customer journey

STAGE	EXPERIENCE	HOW IT IS MEASURED
Discover	Helpful Instagram carousel in freelancer communities; opt-in design-community post.	Relevant visits / engagement
Lead capture	Landing page: “Try a 40-second demo” + optional interest form.	Qualified leads / visitor
Sales	Show a version approval in under 2 minutes; offer INR 299 paid pilot.	Demo-to-paid conversion
Onboarding	Set up one live client review together; explain share-link privacy.	First review created
Delivery	Designer shares link in their own client chat; client approves or asks for changes.	Decisions received / active accounts
Improve	Ask what happened with last approval; observe repeated weekly use.	Re-use, paid renewal, issues

6 Route to the first five customers

Channel A - public trust-building: publish an educational Instagram carousel explaining why “looks good” is not a clear sign-off, targeted to India-based freelance creatives. Comment helpfully in relevant communities where permitted, without spam. **Channel B - targeted, permission-based:** approach known freelance designers or community organisers for permission to share a short personal demo. After the exercise only, seek voluntary discussions with potential customers; no real outreach is required now.

Illustrative funnel, not a forecast: 80 relevant people reached → 24 express curiosity (30%) → 12 take a demo (50%) → 8 start a hands-on pilot (67%) → 5 pay (63%). These conversion rates are deliberately optimistic assumptions. Track every stage; if weak, revise channels or offer before spending more. At INR 299, five pilots yield INR 1,495 of gross pilot revenue, which **does not validate profitability**.

7 Hypothetical INR 10,000 launch allocation

ALLOCATION	INR	INTENT
Customer discovery / local meetups travel	2,000	Interviews and voluntary demo meetings
Reusable content and creator assets	2,000	Educational assets for organic channels
Domain / hosting contingency	1,000	Only if free tier becomes insufficient
Hands-on onboarding and support	1,500	Set up pilot users and fix friction
Community workshops / meetup logistics	1,500	Small permitted, non-ad discovery events
Reserve; release only after positive signals	2,000	Do not spend before value is shown
TOTAL	**10,000**	**Planning ceiling, not money spent**

The full-stack developer is assumed available for five working days, per the brief. Founder/generalist time and developer labour are excluded from this hypothetical cash budget. The 30-day goal is learning and first revenue, not positive unit economics.

Build less. Learn what matters.

The strongest risk is not technical complexity: it is that designers already have “good enough” tools and do not see an additional approval link as worth paying for.

8 What I would test first

First: use public research and the clickable prototype to pressure-test the positioning. In a real post-assignment test, ask 12-15 consenting target designers to walk through their most recent approval process. Request concrete examples, not general opinions. Show FinalOK only after hearing their existing workflow. The team must not claim interviews or demand validation until this happens.

Next: test a concierge pilot with manual setup and a straightforward paid offer. Measure if users send a second review independently, if clients can decide without help, and if anyone pays at the proposed price. Avoid a costly backend until these behaviors appear.

9 Thirty-day decision gates

WINDOW	GOAL / DECISION RULE
Days 1-7: discover	Interview 12-15 consented designers; seek at least 6 with a recent concrete approval problem. Otherwise revisit segment/problem.
Days 8-14: concierge test	Invite at least 8 qualified designers to try sample approvals. If fewer than 4 finish the flow, simplify it before building.
Days 15-21: small build	Support real, revocable links, basic review decisions, status and mobile QA. Fix critical usability and privacy issues.
Days 22-30: paid proof	Aim for 5 genuine paid pilots at INR 299. Continue only if users repeat the flow and at least 5 pay. If interest but no payment, test positioning/price. If little repeat use, stop.

10 Five-day developer handoff

Day 1: project/version model and minimal owner access. **Day 2:** image attachment and unguessable, revocable, time-limited review links. **Day 3:** no-login approve/request-change flow, one decision per version, comment and timestamp. **Day 4:** simple dashboard and mobile responsiveness, manual copy-to-WhatsApp. **Day 5:** QA, file validation, basic access control, consent/privacy notices, bug fixes. **Product owner:** prepare user stories, acceptance tests, onboarding and measurements. Review-link abuse, personal data, access control and uploaded-image retention require production safeguards.

11 What is built for this assignment

Execution sample: an offline HTML landing page with fictional sample artwork, a simulated lead form, project creation, illustrative share-link step, an actual local approve/revise interaction and owner outcome view. These actions run entirely in the browser; no live links, backend, payments, outreach, message sending or production image uploads. This is intentional scope control.

Decision: reject automatic WhatsApp sending and AI-generated feedback summaries for version one. They add integration, privacy and reliability work before the team has established willingness to pay.

Source links - verified desk research (accessed 17 Oct 2026)

[1] Canva sharing/help: canva.com/en_in/help/collaborate-with-anyone-variantb/

[2] Filestage free plan: filestage.io/pricing/

[3] ManyRequests features and pricing: manyrequests.com/pricing

[4] ThePrepLab product scope (idea independence): thepreplab.in/platform-features